

EASIA 237 Pansori Unit 2.mp4

Hello everyone. Welcome back to EASIA 237. This is the lecture for the second unit of our module on pansori in Korea. The topic of today's lecture is the history of this form, including shamanism, popular entertainment, and elite culture, and really an examination of how all of these things kind of work together to develop this form in pre-modern Korean history. So what we'll be covering today is first off just a preview of the assigned reading for this module for this unit. That'll be on slides two to three. So if you haven't already done the reading, I recommend watching at least the first part of the lecture before you go to look at that reading then you know working through those two chapters from the book that I've assigned and then coming back to watch the rest of the lecture again, perhaps in segments.

This may also be a somewhat long discussion because there's a lot to cover. So after I say a few brief things about the reading, I'll go into reviewing some of the important contents from that reading and supplementing them with a few additional details. So the first part of this section is going to be largely inspired by the first chapter from the reading, and I'll stick pretty close to that chapter because it's longer. There's a lot more detail and I think a lot more things that might require a bit of explanation. So, one of the things I'll do is, before I discuss the reading directly, I'll have a bit to say about some general advice or ideas about, you know, what it means to study the origins of one particular cultural phenomenon or another, especially when those origins stretch back into very early pre-modern history.

So, after that kind of general introduction, which I think might be applicable to a lot of different scenarios, we'll deal specifically with some of the things that are covered in the reading. So, this next part is going to address that early history where Pansori comes from simplifying some of the things from the chapter that we've read, emphasizing a few others, and hopefully tying together some things that are addressed in that chapter to make them a bit easier to remember and process. Then, after that, we'll do sort of similar coverage of what is introduced in the second chapter of the assigned reading, but here I'm going to be drawing a lot more from other sources, which, as usual, you can find references for in the additional reading slide that I won't show on screen during this recorded lecture, but you can get when you download the PowerPoint file from the Canvas website.

So I'll be sort of covering a few of the things that the reading addresses related to Pansori and the sort of heyday of its performance in the 19th century, and then also moving a bit further forward into history to sort of make a connection with what we'll be discussing in the next unit of this module that will really be focused on the present day. So I'll try to sort of tie those two things together in today's lecture. Then I'll wrap things up, sort of reiterate a lot of what I've already said from the earlier sections of the, and then, as usual, introduce some of those details for the quiz and brief writing assignment associated with this unit of the module.

So, again, just to provide a kind of roadmap, I recommend that you watch at least the reading

preview section of today's lecture; then go back and have a look at that reading, and then the rest of the lecture. I think we could kind of break up into a few different segments along these lines, again with these numbers in parentheses here telling you which slide of the presentation will be covered in each section of the lecture. So let's talk about the assigned reading from this book entitled *The Korean Singer of Tales*. This is what we call an academic monograph, which means really the entire book is part of an argument about a single topic. It's what we call, you know, a book-length study of a single topic.

So in this case, the individual chapters may not stand alone as well as they would if we were reading a single academic research article or even a chapter from an edited volume. So what I'm doing here is maybe a bit counterintuitive. We're reading just a couple chapters from this book where, if we really wanted to understand what this author was arguing, the sort of points that he was making about pansori in history, we would probably want to read the entire thing. And this is why I'm kind of supplementing the lecture with some bits and pieces from other sources. So the topic of this book is a very far-ranging study of pansori in Korean culture and history that addresses a lot of different sorts of subtopics within this really broad idea.

So the parts we're focusing on are those that most effectively introduce the kind of early social and cultural history of the people who performed these kinds of plays. You might also remember that what we read in the last unit, this full, very heavily annotated translation of an early transcription of one performance of the Song of Shimcheong, is also part of Marshall Peale's study in *The Korean Singer of Tales*. you can kind of consider these two things in relation to one another along with the rest of the chapters that unfortunately we don't have a chance to read that sort of address the history and performance of pansori from a lot of different perspectives. But those first two chapters that we're going to be reading are really focused on, as I said, the early sort of social and cultural history of the kind of social role of the performers, what are referred to here and elsewhere as *gwangdae*. As we see in Peale's lecture, this is a term that's used for.

So here we're talking about this particular role that is the role of the oral performer. In these performances, the first chapter is what we might properly define as antecedents. This is not necessarily about the earliest pansori performances that are really similar to how we understand it today, but sort of tracing some different cultural phenomena that may have played a role in helping to shape the style of performance. It really emerges a little bit later. And this chapter covers a very broad range of topics, stretching back very, very long ago into very ancient Korean history, getting up until the 18th and 19th centuries, during which pansori, as we understand it today, really starts to be very visible in Korean. society.

The second chapter is a little bit shorter, but is a kind of introduction to the role of this performer in the 19th during which pansori is very well documented, has a lot of mostly exactly the same sort of general features that are shared with performances today. And we can really start to see a lot of direct antecedents and sort of lineages of instruction and performance that stretch back a bit further into earlier history, but also extend into the 20th century and even to the present. But really, the focus of this chapter is on those lineages of performance, right? Like where do the actual performers come from? How Do we know what we know about them? And how does the sort of

history of those lineages become a lot more visible and easy to research in the 18th and 19th centuries?

So, a few other thoughts about this reading: just some kind of general points to consider before we move on. This is a scholarly book that's sort of written for specialists in Korean culture and history. It has a lot of detail; it has a lot of proper nouns and a lot of terms from Korean language. And it also, as I pointed out, stretches back very far, sort of deep into early centuries of Korean history. When we read things like this, if we don't feel super well prepared for the kind of depth of scholarship that we're encountering. One way to make this a bit easier is to not worry too much about all of these really specialized terms and loan words from foreign languages, but to sort of use the surrounding context to come up with like workable definitions for these things, not necessarily taking the time to commit them to memory, but focusing instead on what we could call the narrative.

Right? What is the story that the author of this chapter is telling that connects all of these different terms together? Even if we might have sort of lingering definitions about the sort of deeper significance and sort of other connections we can draw with some of those terms. So, sort of use the argument that the author is making to help decide what to prioritize in terms of, you know, words that you think are worth writing down and defining in your notes and staying focused on versus those you could say, OK, this is a kind of interesting name. It seems like this is a probably really deep topic. But my goal today is not to understand every single thing about all of Korean history that's referenced at any point in this chapter, but really just to focus on the topic at hand.

I'll try to review some of those really important terms over the course of today's lecture. And this I think should also help you prepare for the eventual quiz that you'll take for the content introduced in this unit. Beyond that, something where I think it is worth spending a bit more time thinking about, maybe trying to read between the lines a little bit, is to try to come up with your own thoughts. Pay attention as you read to what kinds of evidence the author is citing throughout both of these. I'm especially interested in primary sources, right? Where does the author of these chapters draw directly from clearly identified documents, stuff from archives, written texts that were produced in the period? that he's studying that tell us things about this era of history.

Like you to keep a sort of loose inventory of these things as you read. Again, the titles of these pieces are going to be words in Korean, not quite as important as being able to understand what is the source, what kind of evidence does it provide the author, and where does he cite it in the. These are always really useful things to pay attention to if you're getting lost amidst a kind of complex academic argument about a relatively obscure topic, which is often what we'll be reading in this class. One thing that I think we can do, if we sort of keep note of these sources of evidence as we go is going to work towards our understanding of just the complexity of this kind of why it's sometimes not really possible to make very definitive arguments about earlier periods.

I think what you'll notice is a kind of contrast in the kind of evidence that is used in the first chapter covering very early history and the second chapter, which covers relatively more recent periods of history, mostly 19th kinds of evidence. What sorts of documents or archives or books or other kinds

of writing do we see a lot of references to in the second chapter that we don't necessarily see in that first chapter then? by the same token, what kinds of evidence do we rely on when we want to understand things about this earlier period of history? So, with that out of the way, sort of introduction to the two chapters that we'll be reading for today, I'm gonna change gears for a little bit and talk about some kind of general ideas about the study of the sort of origins of different cultural phenomena or practices.

So, I'll start from what we might assume, right? The sort of goal of research, if we want to study the origins of something, we might understand this as a kind of like linear trajectory, which we can sort of position ourselves here in the present. At the end of this arrow, and then the study of the origin is just going to be looking back in history to find the earliest possible version of whatever this thing is that I'm interested in. This would be great. Perhaps there are some cases in which this is. We have very clearly indicated sort of trajectory from point A to point B in. But often what we actually find out is even in the very simplest scenario, our study of the origins of a particular practice or phenomenon might look a little bit more like this.

And here what I'm kind of attempting to illustrate in my very rudimentary diagram, just this basic fact that's true throughout. all over the world basically with some kind of variation based on chronology and the histories of different places is that the closer we get to the present right here at the side of the the more rich documentation, the more different sources of evidence we'll have access to, the easier it becomes to create a kind of comprehensive account of sort of year by year developments related to one particular phenomenon or another. Now, the further back we go, the more sporadic and irregularly preserved those pieces of evidence become, making it somewhat more challenging to create a sort of linear comprehensive narrative of how we got in history from point A to point B.

And this is still just assuming a relatively straightforward phenomenon or practice that it would theoretically be possible to write a kind of comprehensive linear history of it, just sort of thwarted by irregular access to evidence. The further back we go in history, and so that's one complication. Here's another one. And perhaps you can sort of see what I'm getting at by adding all of these other, sort of especially to the sort of earlier part. What we might actually find, even though we have very sort of sporadically preserved evidence going back much earlier, in we might also discover that it's usually not really possible to sort of trace some phenomenon that seems very sort of self-contained and well-defined in the present all the way back very deep into ancient pre-modern history.

It's often the case that the further back we go and the more sort of expansive our attention to different sources becomes, the more we find that what may look like a single sort of organized, very coherent, well-defined phenomenon in the what it actually results from is this kind of complex amalgamation of influences from a lot of different sources, from a lot of different practices or styles or cultural phenomenon that's not the end of the story. Right? Another thing that we'd have to consider the further back we look in is that the same kind of complexity continues as we move into the present. Right? So we might have also new developments to where, again, what would have looked like a sort of single and consistent line of transmission for one particular practice or another

actually has these kind of branching off points in where new forms or new sort of versions of this thing

start to occur at some point in history and then eventually end up becoming something that, in the present, might feel very different to whatever it is the phenomenon that we're interested in studying is, but in fact have sort of similar points of origin, sort of similar branching-off paths as the product of these complex patterns of influence and development across history. Of course, this can occur at any point, right? It's not the case that this only happens once something is kind of solidified and become relatively straightforward. Some of these earlier branching paths may themselves have other kinds of branching paths intersecting with and sort of mutually influencing the phenomenon that we're interested in. And like as with our very earlier phase, some of these like later branching.

off paths may in fact be the product of kind of multiple streams of influence, you know, some of which may not even really have anything to do with this initial pattern. And then, you know, once we get into more recent, more readily documented stuff, if we're only really looking at these two things, they might seem perfectly discreet and unrelated to one another, even though the further back in history we go, the more we find they kind of intersect and influence one another in somewhat unexpected ways. So I'm being very general here, right? We could perhaps think of examples of all of these things. Pansori is definitely one of them. But this pattern is really not exclusive to this particular form.

And I think if we can kind of recall some of these diagrams when we study other phenomena from pre-modern history, we might find the situation to be quite similar to say the least. So with all of that out of the way, with our kind of complex model of the sort of challenges on the study of origins, let's try to do this right. Let's still try to say like where did pansori come from, keeping in mind that our answer to this question is going to look a little bit more like the last slide from that earlier section and not so much like the very neat and easy to document sort of simplistic. straight arrow from point A to point B.

We began that section with So if we wanted to put a name to some of the biggest sort of sources of influence, sort of sources of inspiration for this form, we might address these three big categories, keeping in mind that there are also like interactions and convergences between the two, right? We could think about the influence of shamanism on pansori performance, the influence of court and palace culture, that is sort of entertainment and ceremonial culture at this kind of elite aristocratic level. We might also think about popular entertainment, stage performances, outdoor shows. that are being presented for the masses, right? Perhaps some audience members from these elite contexts would, you know, go out into cities and villages to witness these things.

A lot of other people that didn't have access to court and palace culture also would have been audiences for that early popular entertainment. So we'll talk through all three of these different areas of influence or sort of contexts in which pansori developed, with our overall point being that it's really not possible to think of any one of these as like a singular origin point of pansori. We might also want to, on our sort of understanding or characterization. of this form if we wanted to

emphasize one of those over all of the others. In some cases, it's, you know, really necessary and useful to do this, and I'll sort of talk through some of those because we can really start to distinguish, well, if we want to say that parts of pansori originate in these shamanistic practices, well, what parts are we talking about, right?

What are the, you know, sort of aspects of these ancient and ongoing religious and ritual practices? But there's also a sort of less useful way I would say, perhaps, that we might decide to influence one of these spheres over the others, which would be to kind of exaggerate certain aspects of contemporary performance while downplaying some of the others, right? For example, if we, you know, only discussed the emergence of pansori from within this kind of elite culture of the palace, of the kind of aristocratic, you know, class of pre-modern Korea, we might end up presenting a version of the art form that looks like it's always been kind of highbrow, exclusive, obscure entertainment that only really appeals to the elite, right?

This would be overlooking this other aspect of the form, was at certain points in history very much a kind of mass media entertainment, sort of mass market entertainment that appealed to people from across the social spectrum. On the other hand, if we were to only influence this, only emphasize this kind of popular entertainment context in which, you know, some of these things occurred, we might overlook the fact that there's a lot of, you know, elements of certain styles of pansori practice that would have only really been appealing or, like, interesting to those in these kind of elite circles, right? So exaggerating or emphasizing one of these sort of areas of influence over the others might cause us to overlook some aspects, even of pansori performance in the present day.

So, some other things to consider. First off, just the sort of general idea that the further back we go in history, the less likely we are to have written documentation that's comprehensive is true of all kinds of different things. It's even true of literature. It's something that we imagine to exist primarily in the form of written documents. But it's especially true if what we're talking about are orally transmitted practices that didn't, at earlier points in their history, really depend on material writing in any way. These would be things that are taught from a student, or rather, taught by a teacher to their student face to face, without any need to write things down. And then, of course, performed to an audience who would listen and watch the performance and not necessarily worry about reading it.

Talked a bit about how the sort of written forms of the like scripts or transcriptions of performances become fairly popular and widespread later in history. But very early on this wasn't the case. This was a sort of cultural tradition that was not written down, or at least if it was written down, it was not sort of preserved in written form in a way that we can access it very easily today. And so, on top of just a general limitation in the amount of written texts we have that sort of document different aspects of performance. The texts that we do have tend to be those that are produced within this context of court and palace culture. They're written by the elite, largely for the elite, and seem sort of narrowly focused on what's going on within the confines of the capital buildings, the official headquarters of government, and the royal family in the palace.

All of these kind of more exclusive places that are populated primarily just by the literate elite, which going back into pre-modern history would have been like a fairly small subset of society. So, keeping all of this in mind, what can we say about the earliest Cultural practices that contributed to the development of pansori performance. The first chapter of the reading has a really interesting section that goes into detail about a kind of deep history of shamanism and other forms of religious ceremony and ritual practice in very early Korean history. So, I guess I'll preface this by saying that not a lot of this is like directly related to the history of pansori, right? We're sort of providing a deeper history of some of these ceremonial and ritual practices, which give us two things.

First, of what they give us is a window into the role of oral performance and kind of, you know, embodied. performance people acting something out, people sort of doing things with gesture and movement while performing orally that may not have like a direct relationship to contemporary forms of popular entertainment but still represent the sort of presence of ceremony and performance in early Korean society. But there are also some kind of theoretical connections we can make, perhaps to how we can actually trace a kind of like ancestry or sort of lineage from those very, very early forms of ceremony and performance into both this kind of religious ritual practice which we kind of conveniently label shamanism, as well. as into other forms of you know performance and entertainment.

So with that kind of complex introduction out of the way, one I think key term that's worth remembering or sort of thinking about because this is really hugely significant in early Korean history is this group of people very early on that were called Hwara. These would be young men from elite families that would, you know, for a period of their youth in their sort of teen years, kind of late teen mid late teen years, men from these elite families would go engage in military training and then also learn to you know particular kinds of roles in ritual performance and ceremony. So this is both kind of practical training for future careers as officials or military generals. But they also, while they're engaging in this, are performers of the sort that have a lot of like different functions during that particular period.

So the idea, again, is that they're sort of doing this in preparation for their later careers. It's a sort of temporary position that one holds before they would become a general or a government official. But while they're doing this, right, while they're doing this kind of training, they also take on roles as performers of ceremonies, rituals, and other kinds of court. activities. So, Pil traces a kind of complex, like up and down, of the social role throughout early Korean history. I think we can summarize it really briefly by saying that this role, which really emphasized spoken performance and kind of ceremony and movement as a way of kind of training for military and civil service, and you know, book learning, we call it simply as sort of textual culture, became more and more prominent in pre-modern Korean society.

There were a lot of other forms of training that became necessary for those who wanted to prepare for military and civil service. This is just one factor, right? There's lots of other. issues influencing this. But basically, what we see are kind of periods of decline and sporadic revival of this institution throughout early Korean history. So, on the one hand, this again it gives us a kind of brief glimpse at some other roles that ceremony and performance played in very early Korean court culture. On

the other hand, we also have this kind of theory or idea that perhaps, you know, this culture of those who had experienced this kind of training, the sort of preparation for like a particular style of ceremonial performance, perhaps those traditions were maintained outside of the court, right?

And those who the Sort of descendants of those who, at one point, would have trained eventually to prepare for roles as generals or civil officials. Once you know, the paths to civil service became more complex; perhaps they continued to pass these techniques down. But for those who would be sort of conducting these performances outside of this context of the palace and civil service, this is a sort of possible origin point for all of these different kinds of ritual and ceremonial practices that would lead to different styles of shamanism, different kinds of entertainment culture, lots of other possibilities here. So when it comes to shamanism. itself again this is a very complex topic. Its intersection with pansori is relatively straightforward, but this might be something that if it interests us, we could turn to some of those additional readings and go into the steeper of religious ritual practice in pre-modern Korea.

What's conveniently labeled shamanism, the closer we look at it, the more we realize there's different versions of this, different regional variations, lots of different complexity to that as well. But basically when we talk about shamanism, kinds of rituals or performances we're referring to, are those that in some way are kind of intended. to interact with or communicate with deities, right? With sort of divine forces that kind of regular everyday people are not necessarily able to witness or communicate with. The shamans are almost like intermediaries, right? They may speak on behalf of those deities may also convey messages from regular people those deities' requests, anything like this, right? So there are these kind of intermediaries between this divine realm of gods and supernatural forces and people.

So lots of variety here, lots of potential for different styles of shamanist practice some cases, and the ones that are emphasized most in this chapter. this became kind of a hereditary profession, right? So, if your parent, if your mother, for example, was one of these shamans, you would then kind of inherit this role and have training to conduct those rituals as part of your family career, right? This is not the case in all regions. It was in the one that Peale is focusing on in this case. It's also true that, in this region, in this sort of hereditary sort of people that actually performed these rituals, performed these kind of ceremonies to interact with divine forces, were women. So, this would be passed from mothers to, according to generation within these families, men from the same.

families would participate in the rituals by providing kind of rhythmic or musical accompaniment, might receive some of the same training, but the actual role of the shaman would be performed by the women. So this is, among other things, it's a style of performance. It involves rhythmic recitation of incantations or different messages. It involves a mix of singing and narration. And it's also something that might be performed in front of an audience of people as well. So maybe the goal of this practice is to communicate with some kind of... But, of course, the people who are also in your community can witness and appreciate it. in any way they want. They may simply like to see the spectacle. They may be involved with the religious tradition.

They may have been entertained by the stories and songs that were sung as part of these chaman performances. There's lots of different possibilities there. What's interesting about this is that, and I'll talk a bit more about some other aspects of this connection, but one of the things that's become clearer and clearer, the more that we study these things, is that there actually is, beyond just this kind of general similarity of rhythmic vocal performance, there are close relationships between some of these. chaman songs and the kind of melodies and rhythms of pansori performance on a kind of like musical logical level, right? The same kind of beats are used, the same sort of ideas about mode and pace. There's some pretty close relationship in the sort of technical elements of the music performed in chaman songs from this particular tradition and the rhythms and melodies, and so on, of pansori as we understand it today. So here we're getting closer to something that we can kind of present as a little bit more concrete, right? Sort of concrete, perhaps predecessors, perhaps interrelated performing arts styles.

But turning our attention away from that to think about performance in the context of later court and palace culture. We could sort of talk about the decline, sort of rise and fall of the hwarang as like an institution and sort of social status for young men in court culture. This is something that sort of has a beginning and has more or less an ending, but this isn't the end of the idea that palace and court culture involves ceremony and performance of some kind. The sort of reception of this is different later in history, by which I mean there's like a lot of different opinions about the value of these kinds of performances. But it is true that some kind of performance, some kind of entertainment culture continues to exist within the sort of bureaucracy and palace of the royal family.

He'll use a lot of different terms to refer to this. I think a kind of general one we can just understand as stage plays, basically a kind of variety of performance that might include a lot of different kinds of performers either performing together or performing one after another: right, acrobatics, music, oral performance. You might get a little bit of all of them in any one of these performances. And these would be things that were going on within the palace, right? Within this sort of secluded area meant only for those kinds of elite aristocratic families. These later forms of performance had a lot of different functions. They retained some of their sort of ceremonial or ritual aspects. We might also think of them as, you know, sort of tending more towards just entertainment for all of the different people living within the palace.

Or, and I think most interestingly, there's the idea that these performers, especially the sort of oral performers, would come in to recite things like folk songs, speeches, or like essays that were composed in order to communicate some kind of important information from the public right from everyone who's living outside of the palace would come in from those communities and sing their songs, do their performances as a form of, you know, perhaps critique, recommendation, what we call like remonstrance, right? Like offering perhaps uncomfortable advice as sort of offering this perspective from outside the palace to those living within it. And sometimes we might have a blend of all three, right? So these performances were popular in general among the palace residents. And in fact, there were some officials and rulers that really valued this idea that what you're getting is some kind.

of you know communication of information from outside the palace walls. But at the same time, there were also those within the same community that found these kinds of performances sort of frivolous, wasteful, distracting, or perhaps even sort of rude, impolite. It's not really proper to criticize the king in this way. So what we see, the more access to kind of text from cult culture that we have, the more we see that this wasn't something that was either universally embraced or universally critiqued, but that we actually have a kind of complex discourse going on within this elite community about what is the ultimate value. of these many different kinds of performance culture that exists within the palace.

And so, thinking back to this idea that what we're getting are sort of insight from the community, those performers, these kuang dai performers, and in this context, you'll actually sometimes see this translated as something like jester, performing a kind of similar role. This is entertainment, but it's also a form of advice and critique and sort of information about the outside world. These are people that we understand who have been coming from basically the same hereditary class as the shamans and their partners. These sort of male. accompanists to the female shamans would have also received some kind of performance training, and they could use this to become some of these court performers. So we can sort of think of a contrast here where this sort of earlier form, the huarang kind of role, came from within these elite communities.

In this later context of court and palace culture, these entertainers are coming from different classes, and it's one that's kind of generally shared by those that at this point would be acting as shamans out in other communities, other kinds of ritual performances like this. So this kind of brings us to this other sphere of performance and entertainment culture in pre-modern times. These are performers who also probably put on presentations, put on shows outside of the context of the court as well. This probably wasn't the case for everybody. Perhaps some of those performers would have catered exclusively to this elite audience. Others likely would have catered exclusively to a sort of mass popular audience, but there were also those that went back and forth between these two contexts.

And this is something that could have gone on even after or in sort of periods where these kinds of performances were less welcome in the court. These people have to go somewhere. The theory that Peale presents is that they would have sort of left the court and then gone out to the people, continuing doing what they knew how to do, which was to put on performances, but doing this for different audiences. Unfortunately, here's where we really encounter the issue of absence of evidence. We have some relatively thorough documentation for what's going on within the palace walls and within elite circles in pre-modern times. We know less about what would have happened to these people after they were no longer in the court.

But one of the things that we can sort of deduce from this, or sort of assume is that if they are these entertainers that are kind of coming from this particular hereditary class going on to become performers that may have at one point in their lives had the ear of those in the palace, and then perhaps returning to this kind of commoner afterwards, it seems likely that this would have been a fairly productive area for developing a kind of style of performance that would have appealed to both elite and common audiences. So it might have some kind of sophisticated references to

philosophy, history, and this kind of elite cultural tradition of the court. But it also would have had content that would have had more sort of mainstream mass appeal that didn't depend on a really high level of education to fully appreciate.

So this is one possible period during which this sort of mass appeal style of performance that had both allusion and sort of sophisticated content and also other aspects to it. As to kind of briefly summarize some of the major changes in popular mass appeal entertainment from the 17th to 19th century, we might document a kind of trend towards urbanization. This is true in a lot of different places. It's true in Korea as well. As we have people gathering into more densely populated cities, of course. we have new audiences and new locations at which public performances might occur. think Peale mentions that earlier they would have been performing in kind of like fishing villages; later, as larger cities develop in other places.

We also see performance culture becoming an important component of this kind of like new urban environment of these newly developed cities. Another thing that we see is the sort of appearance of audiences that have kind of similar tastes to this kind of elite aristocratic community that develop among non-aristocratic families who become wealthy, who are sort of able to accrue wealth and again in this new context of kind of new urbanization, new industries, new ways of accumulating wealth. The more people that become very wealthy through various different professions, the more sort of expansion of a group of potential patrons who might hire these entertainers becomes. So we have these sort of new groups of people that are able to pay for and support the livelihood of those trained primarily as entertainers and performers.

So another thing, in some ways we can think of as being kind of independent to all this, we just have more and more writing being produced the later we go in, and especially, you know, more and more writing being preserved. The closer we get to the present, it's kind of a truism, right? The more access to documents from the past we have. So it's kind of hard to say, are we talking about, you know, texts that just happen to have preserved, or are we talking about an actual like new style of writing? There's lots of examples of both. But what we do say, you know, the sort of trend from the 17th and 19th century is that we tend to see more and more written texts that actually address elements from day to day life: more written evidence of things, again, going on outside of the palace.

And this would include, of course, you know, more detailed documentation of these kinds of performances that wouldn't necessarily have had any kind of like written incarnation in earlier periods. So the result of this is that, you know, over the course of the 17th and really 18th centuries, by the time we get to the 19th century, what we can see is that performances that look really similar to Pansori, as we understand it today, are already very, like, well attested in several different kinds of written sources. But this question is, you know, how do we get from these sort of earlier styles of ceremony and performance to, in this kind of late 18th, early 19th century moment where we see, oh, now there's this thing that looks almost exactly like Pansori as we understand it today.

So this is a topic that has been researched and debated really throughout the 20th century, right? This has been a really captivating topic of research for a lot of scholars, both within and outside of

Korea. More or less, I don't know that there's 100% consensus on this, but the kinds of explanations of this that you tend to see these days are an acknowledgment of the really important role of the music and kind of rhythms of these shaman songs, especially those of the Jeolla region in this kind of southwestern Korean southwestern sort of coastal region. We can see the similarities between the styles of music that are used in those shaman songs and the styles of music that are used in Pansori performance. So this is a really important detail that's been more confirmed through recent research.

And so from this point we can understand that there are these male performers that are kind of accompanying female shamans and then kind of use the training, as the theory goes, that they would have received to do this kind of accompaniment to also work on their own as entertainers outside of this kind of ritual religious context. Those entertainers would be able to move between classes. They could perform to the palace; they could perform to the villages; they could perform in. They could attract audiences of elite and commoners alike. And so, it's kind of this multifaceted context in which the performance style now known as Pansori really takes shape. It's a kind of complex, multifaceted sphere. So, this connection, this idea that these musical styles and sort of traditions of performance came from these shamanistic practices in the Cholla region was first theorized in the 1940s.

So, actually, pretty early on in the academic study of the history of this form, both before that and since then, a lot of other theories have been advanced, sort of looking at one potential source of influence, the others to sort of pinpoint, well, where does Pansori actually come from? And some of these have pointed to very different possible origins. So, in one case, a very sort of early theory was like, kind of looking at the popularity of Pansori novels, which we talked about in unit one, these kind of written, what we now understand to be written transcriptions of performances that predate the text. Only this kind of textual material evidence, there was a theory that in fact the written form came first, right? That this was a kind of written.

style of that was then adapted into a performance style later in. So this was one kind of early theory about the relationship between these written texts and the later performances. Another theory sort of emphasized the role that would have been played by a kind of similar literary and performing arts traditions of China, which we know to have like played a fairly major role in both the sort of and cultural history of Korea. Right? So there's this idea either that books would have kind of found their way into the Korean peninsula by way of like trade routes from China, and those kinds of narrative traditions found in those. Books would have kind of sort of performing arts culture.

There's a kind of complimentary theory looks mostly at like maritime travel, especially between this kind of Southwest region of the Korean peninsula and kind of Southeastern like coastal cities in China, saying that oh, there was actually not just like books traveling back and forth between Korea and China, but in fact, like performers would have like gone into Korea and sort of performed there. And those like traveling Chinese performers would have then inspired, you know, Korean performing arts traditions as well. Another theory posits the role and influence of shamanism from other parts of Korea. As I mentioned very briefly, this is a really deep topic. There's lots of regional

variations of these kinds of practices. At different points in history, scholars have wondered if those other traditions of shamanism from throughout Korea may have actually, perhaps, played more of a role than those shamans active in the southwestern coastal region of the peninsula.

Yet another theory that has been advanced is that sort of positing that what we really have is a kind of classical and elite tradition of recitation that sort of influences the rest of popular culture from the top down. Sort of understanding this to have been a form that developed from within this kind of narrow elite cultural tradition and then eventually was kind of disseminated out to the people from there. One thing that we can say is that it's not really the case that any of these theories were necessarily discarded. I would say, with the exception of this first one, that the kind of textual written form of the pansori narratives actually comes before the performances. I think this has been fairly thoroughly discredited, disproven in a manner of speaking.

But kind of elements of all of these other factors certainly played a role in. the kinds of stories that were being told and sort of elements of the performance. So it's not the case that we can really rule out any of these other sources as potential areas of influence on pansori as we understand it today. But it's also the more of these potential streams of influence we talk about, the harder it becomes to say that any one of these things is the true ancestor or predecessor of this performance art form. So we might say that there are certainly some styles of performance that really draw very heavily on Chinese narrative traditions. It's a kind of matter of fact that several of the five most frequently.

performed very old pansori pieces are kind of based on Chinese history and literature. So there's some kind of influence coming in from these other regions. This is certainly part of it. But it becomes harder and harder to say, you know, oh, all of this is a kind of like foreign performing arts form that's then just kind of imported onto the peninsula. The more that these other sort of multifaceted sources of influence have to be considered. So certainly, ongoing research is going to provide depth to our understanding of these things, but it might be harder to identify a kind of single direct ancestor to this performing arts. style

So, regardless of some of those mysteries, some of those unresolved questions about very, very early predecessors to the form as we know it, once we get into the 19th century, it becomes very easy to kind of document many more aspects of the kind of development and emergence of this form in Korea. We might point at a few different kind of areas to look at from across the 19th and 20th century. Context should look at the popularization of the form, right? Throughout the 19th century, it becomes a sort of widespread form of popular entertainment and there's a lot more performances going on, right? There's new audiences for those. performances. There's more and more people engaging in the performance. And then there's also, like, new forms of documentation to tell us what those performances were like.

Another thing to consider is what we could label modernization, right? The sort of ongoing transformation of elements of pansori in response to other things going on in the 19th and 20th centuries, other sort of social and cultural aspects of history from this modern period. And this involves the emergence of new forms of technology. Very first, you know, being not really a new

form of technology, but the sort of newly widespread access to text, newly sort of widespread literacy leading to one of the first of these developments we've already kind of talked about the sort of publications or dissemination of pansori in written form. These pansori novels which we read one example of in the first unit. But there are a few other sort of technical innovations that also contribute to changes in how pansori is received and performed later in modern history.

We might also think about what we've referred to in this class as heritagization, right? A sort of process through which a kind of living cultural tradition becomes heritage, right? A sort of durable national tradition. which involves, in some cases, like new visibility. Sort of introduction of the source to new audiences, especially like international audiences. But also often comes with a sort of, you know, narrowed view of what that form can be, right? A sort of newly standardized understanding, perhaps some more rules. You know, it has to be preserved in exactly this way to prevent this legacy from the past from fading away entirely. It needs to be kind of monitored and maintained and revitalized according to the principles of the past, right?

So in some ways, this kind of heritagization process has the effect of like freezing a style in time. and saying like this is what we want to preserve. Is this, you know, sort of most authentic, most sort of traditional version of it? And so all of these are important elements of the kind of ongoing transformation of pansori in the 19th and 20th centuries. So let's look first a little bit about this heyday, right? This kind of 19th century context that Marshall Peale discusses in the second of the two chapters that we read for today. So hopefully, as you read this, you notice that he addresses some really interesting and new sources of. He talks about a transcription of a performance of one of the more famous pieces that was translated.

into Chinese, sort of predating these later pansori novels, would be written in Korean. This is a kind that's translated into Chinese. He also talks about some other literary forms that happen to mention outdoor performances, mostly poetry, both long and short poems. They may be poems about something else that happen to mention an outdoor performance. There's also one really interesting, very early example of a poem that's a kind of long, rhapsodic discussion of an outdoor performance, from which we get the both of like what a pansori performance in the 19th century would have looked like and also like how the person. Witnessing it would have connected it to what they understood about pansori in its kind of broader context, having a history that stretches back even further.

And then there's also kind of similar attention to, like, lineages of performers, right? So writing about who are the sort of most famous, most interesting performers of the day, and then also, like, who are those performers' teachers? Who are those teachers? And going back further into past generations, which we can use to kind of reconstruct some of these lineages of performers, going back into the 18th century, let's say. And so from these new sources, we can get a lot of like. different details about the kinds of performances that were occurring in the 19th. And here is, you know, this performance style that is more or less like pansori as we understand it today, right? We have the kwangdae, the singer, the oral performer, accompanied only by a rhythm section, a drummer that makes these occasional, like, interjections.

What we start to see more and more often in the 19th is that there are performances that might include only those two people. Whereas in earlier contexts, we might've seen the style of performance as part of what we've called like a variety show, right? It might have a lot of other different kinds of performance involved with it. Because this particular style only takes two people, you don't need a lot of props; you don't need a particular kind of setting. This is something that can start to occur more and more frequently, even if you don't have any other kinds of other performers present. And what we also start to see pretty early on is what we might call a standard repertoire of 12 pieces.

Now, as I mentioned last week, there's some, you know, uncertainty, some debate about whether this is actually exactly 12 or if 12 is being used as just a sort of general number. But we do tend to see it referred to often enough that we can understand that they're really like 12 prominent, you know, what we might call like narrative cycles or pieces that these performers would perform over and over again, right? This is the kind of standard repertoire. These 12 pieces, including, you know, all five of those which are sort of thought to constitute the traditional corpus today, plus several more that are no longer performed, some of which have been, you know, completely lost. We know their titles and a few things about them, but beyond that, not much has been preserved.

So what we can also gather from this is that because we have these kinds of written sources, we know that they come from these kinds of literate elite people from various backgrounds. And so we know that in addition to coming from this kind of hereditary class and sort of working as entertainment for the masses, we know that these are performers that are engaging with people from all walks of life and they become so popular that we even start to see people training to become performers that don't come from this kind of traditional hereditary background that would have in earlier periods been the only group of people producing these kinds of. Further, we go into history, the more we see these kinds of outsiders who don't.

belong to this hereditary class but are nevertheless interested in learning how to put on these performances on their own. So in some ways this is a kind of like diversifying effect, right? That this is a sort of style of performance that appeals to a lot of different people from a lot of different backgrounds. But there's also, even initially, kind of like a narrowing effect of this as well in that if these elite viewers, especially, you know, those responsible for becoming the patrons of different performers, there's a kind of narrowing of the style of performance that is popular among this elite audience. And so if they're the ones who are kind of supporting the livelihoods of the performers.

We start to see already the like 12; the kind of standard repertoire is already being sort of narrowed down into a more limited range of pieces based on the kind of values and preferences of that audience that's responsible for acting as patrons to those performers. On the one hand, it's a period during which pansori becomes very widespread, very popular. But on the other hand, it's also a time when we start to see the sort of range of performance narrowing a little. And these general trends continue over the course of the 19th century with the sort of result that by the late 19th century Pansori has both widespread popularity and kind of extensive documentation, but also this really deep and sophisticated culture of connoisseurs and critics.

So, people that might be very focused on saying, oh, that should be this way, this performance should be done that way, this needs to be like this, these are the things you can appreciate about it. These are like the most acceptable styles and so on. So, this kind of culture of connoisseurship by the end of the 19th century is also very prominent. So, when it comes to the early 20th century, some of these trends continue. In some cases, there's like new developments as well, important of which you know, often associated with this kind of transition from 19th 20th century, people need to contend with new forms of technology. So one of the things that emerges in this period is recording, the ability to take somebody's performance and put it on a record so that it can be reproduced by anybody that has the record and the record player.

You no longer have to go to watch a live performance. You can buy a record that has a recording on it. So this has two big effects. On the one hand, it expands the audience quite a bit, right? It expands the degree to which that audience can engage with the performance. They can listen to it over and over again as often as they want without having to go out and watch a live show. But because of some of the technical limitations of early recordings, these are often, rather than getting a six to eight hour full performance, you would buy a record that has maybe a selection of songs, maybe from a few different performances, maybe from one piece, you know, like different ways of organizing this.

And the kind of prevalence of those shorter recordings then has this other effect of saying, well, you know, there's really the market just for only the performance of this really popular song. And so then, in their live performances, they might cater to those kinds of audience that might prefer a shorter performance. They might prefer only to hear the song that they want to hear, which kind of starts to encourage these kinds of like shorter live performances that we see even today, as opposed to like very long, you know, multi-phase, six to eight hour performances with intermissions that take a whole day to perform. There's also kind of concurrent developments in just the kind of like commercial and marketing apparatus surrounding these recordings, but also surrounding the kind of organization of live performances.

as well. Somewhat, you know, more nuanced area to get into, but this is something that does play a major role in the early 20th century. On the other hand, there's also, even within this realm of what we might understand to be like traditional performance style, new forms of stage play, those that involve like multiple performers, also become popular in this period. Now we talked about, you know, other styles of performance in earlier periods of history. Then we have the kind of rise of popularity of these sort of two-person performances in the 18th and 19th century. Well, in the late 19th and early 20th century, these kind of like multi Actor stage plays kind of come back into popularity in a really kind of new form, drawing a lot of influence from contemporary theatrical productions in other parts of the world, but which have some kind of connection, perhaps, to these older forms of multi-performer stage plays in earlier history, in which you might have the same story, right?

Let's say the story of Sim Chong, which we read an excerpt of in a pansori version. There might be a theatrical-like stage play that would have, instead of just one oral performer doing all of the different voices, you'd have like multiple actors performing those different roles on stage. plays

these both compete with and have a kind of influence on pansori as well. Another new form of technology also introduces like another potential side of influence, but also really a big competitor. We're thinking of pansori as in the 19th century really playing the role of kind of like mass entertainment for people from all backgrounds, people who are interested in narrative from all walks of life. When we have the introduction of cinema as a kind of similar form, right, it's storytelling, it's visual, it involves like going out to a theater to watch it.

Cinema can also be used as a medium to adapt a lot of these same popular stories. So there is some mutual influence here, as is the case with stage plays as well. But what we also see is that audience preferences maybe are kind of fickle. More people start to prefer just going out to see the movies rather than, you know, going to watch a pansori performance even in this kind of early 20th-century context. And one of the interesting outcomes of this is that this, you know, competition from cinema as a kind of comparable but perhaps more alluring, you know, new high-tech, new style kind of leads to the first very deliberate efforts to revitalize pansori. Right. So people are seeing like, oh, people aren't as interested.

In coming out to see pansori as they used to be, you know, maybe five, ten years ago. So we need to take deliberate efforts to like protect and revive and like encourage interest in this traditional art form again. This happens largely in order to compete with like cinema as a competitor medium. Another major influence on how you know many different aspects of Korean culture and history unfolded in the early and mid-20th century. It's really, you know, impossible to overlook the role played by the colonial occupation of Korea by this kind of, you know, expanding Japanese empire in the late 19th, early 20th century. On the one hand, this leads to censorship of a lot of different kinds of cultural practice, especially those that could be perceived as, you know, encouraging resistance to the Japanese occupying forces.

So, on the one hand, we have these kind of restrictions and limitations, you know, pushed upon pansori performers. On the other hand, we have this kind of pressure or coercion to sort of like alter or maybe create new kinds of performance that would, like, promote the occupying government, right? So there's this kind of pressure to insert pro-colonial propaganda into not just pansori performance, but lots of other realms of like popular entertainment. During this period, we also see situations in which Pansori performers are kind of conscripted, not just to perform in the context, you know, that they would have traditionally been performing, but they're kind of like taken away from those contexts and taken to perform to kind of entertain soldiers of like the occupying forces in these sort of state-run facilities.

So, sort of new context for performance, ones that might be, you know, certainly unpleasant to think about, but it is a factor that contributes to what Pansori would have looked like during this period of colonization and restriction under the Japanese Empire. This is important not just for understanding this, you know, 1920s, 30s, early 40s context, but also as a way of understanding what comes after, right? This kind of rupture, or sort of interruption to what was going on with Pansori performance prior to this, creates a cascading effect that has consequences later in history. So when we think of this like post-war era, right after the defeat of Japan in the Second World War, after their retreat from the Korean Peninsula, we have another really major historical factor in, you

know, 20th century Korean history: the division of Korea into two, you know, concurrent and competing regimes.

in the North and South, which is another form of like interruption. Causes dispersal of a lot of different groups and centers of performance, one that also has kind of cascading effects into the present as well. But what we also see in this, you know, mid and late 20th century context, are sort of national agencies that are established, especially in South Korea, to kind of oversee and maintain the traditional performing arts, right? These sort of agencies that are devoted to really, as we can understand it in this class, heritagization, right? The kind of preservation, maintenance, and protection of traditional performing arts. So this is a good opportunity to sort of segue into what we'll be talking about in the next unit, but to sort of stay within this kind of mid-20th century context.

So we can sort of point to the 60s as when this kind of revitalization, sort of heritagization movement for Pansori really takes off at full speed. This is a period during which this performing arts style is kind of elevated to the status of national heritage culture, in which case it's kind of recognized as a tradition that needs to be protected and maintained to some degree. As is often the case with this kind of heritagization process, this results in sort of further Narrowing of the kind of variety that we see in this style, right? It's an effort to protect Pansori as it once was, as opposed to just sort of letting culture unfold, like naturally, quote unquote, right?

It's a complex issue to think about, but basically what we see is that there's a kind of standardization of the styles, themes, and repertoires that are promoted, that are sort of recognized as the most prominent and important examples, which leads to further sort of disconnection from those styles that are not kind of recognized as being important to the kind of traditional, authentic version of the culture. In some cases, you can see how this would be really necessary and makes a lot of sense, right? If this is a form that's been really heavily influenced by things that went on during this phase of Japanese occupation, this sort of effort to revitalize and restore it seems kind of logical, right?

That you want to say, well, no, we can kind of take away this kind of messy and unpleasant period of history and figure out how can we get back to the way that it used to be. But from another perspective, this also involves a kind of narrowing of the vision of what might represent the sort of most authentic, most traditional form of the art. There's also the matter of it becoming elevated as a kind of high art form, as something that's important because of its connections to history and culture, of a sort of like lost cultural tradition, rather than something that is just one of many different kinds of mass entertainment that audiences can choose between. Right?

And so it's kind of put on a pedestal, in a manner of speaking, as like a sort of very sophisticated performing art, rather than as something that just appeals to people from all walks of life. Another effect of this revitalization movement is that you might note the fact that we went back over these different theories of the origins. of Pansori. A lot of those theories kind of materialized during this revitalization movement. There's a sort of renewed interest not just in the performance and appreciation of Pansori, but a renewed interest in understanding its past, understanding it as

cultural heritage, as something that has a history that we can study and research and value. So, this same kind of revitalization movement is also an initiator of a lot of this kind of scholarly attention to the form.

Some of these theories originate earlier, but this ongoing study of the history of Pansori becomes much more popular in this mid-late 20th century context. It's in the late 1970s, I believe, that we start to see a lot of really in-depth musicological analysis that really brings to light some of the musical similarities between those shaman songs and styles of Pansori performance. This is not the first time this theory has advanced, but it does give it a lot more strength. It makes it a lot more persuasive when we can really point very meticulously to these kinds of musical similarities between those two performance traditions. So, on the one hand, we can think of all of this as part of this kind of heritagization process for Pansori, by which a form of mass entertainment becomes.

a sort of elevated traditional performing arts style. But this is not the only thing going on in this period, and this is really what we'll be focusing on next week. So, on the one hand, we might think of this kind of revitalization movement as being sponsored primarily by these sort of like agencies sponsored by this kind of effort to create a newly standardized vision of traditional national culture. But these are not the only people who are interested in performing and kind of using Pansori for different performances. So what we also see in the same period is that the traditional performing arts can also become a way to express activism and protest that sort of new plays can be written in these older traditional styles that are going to much more directly to issues that matter to people in contemporary times.

So, some of these are written very explicitly as forms of like political critique or political satire. Perhaps, you know, also thinking about Pansori as a tradition that has a right stretching back to these earlier forms of court entertainment, through which the entertainers would kind of voice their opinions, voice their ideas about society, often kind of critical and like mocking, right? So, they're sort of taking one aspect of the tradition's history and using it in the present to also express like activism and critique. On the other hand, there's also like lots of styles of Pansori that might not have the same political satire edge to them that are like newly composed pieces, newly composed plays that are, in a way, we can think of them as sort of a different style of revitalization movement, which is a way of saying no, our goal is not to preserve and maintain Pansori as it once was,

but to show that this is a really versatile and exciting form of art that can be used to tell all kinds of different stories. Right? So new pieces can be written that will use the kind of singing techniques and recitation style of Pansori, but using them to tell stories that might be more engaging to contemporary audiences. So again, they can be both to act in contrast to, or to critique the interests and needs of the state. It can also be used just as a different form of entertainment, which is in a way another way of revitalizing and maintaining the tradition. So I'm getting ahead of myself, perhaps. This is something that we'll address in a lot more detail in the next unit: what we call generally new pansori sort of performances of pansori that don't rely on that five-piece traditional repertoire.

that becomes the sort of standard form in the 20th century to summarize, to kind of recap this very long history that we've covered over the course of today's lecture. So we can say it's definitely true that spoken and sung performance of some kind, often with musical accompaniment, has a really long history. No one would dispute this. There are lots of different examples of performing arts traditions stretching back very deep into Korean history. But the problem is precise details are difficult to find. The connections between these forms are hard to establish because of kind of limited access to material evidence. From premodern history, we can start to say a lot more kinds of concrete details about pansori in particular, roughly the 18th.

So, we know that this is kind of a key area in which we see, or can sort of presume, most of the features we now associate with pansori to already kind of be in process. And basically, what I mean by this is that, you know, in the early 19th century, it's fairly clear that there's a well-established performing arts tradition that involves two performers, one of whom provides the dialogue and narration, and one of whom provides, like, rhythmic accompaniment from a drum, with, you know, occasional interaction between those two performers. But what we also see is that often in this early context, this is just one component of a show that might also have lots of different styles of performance in it.

Likewise, we know that at some point in the 18th, there was probably a fixed repertoire of some kind that consisted most likely of 12 pieces, but we're really not sure exactly what that means, right? We have these lists of 12 titles. In some cases, we have other references to 12 that seem like they may just be using 12 as a reference to, like, many something like this, right? So there is still some uncertainty and debate about at what point this kind of fixed repertoire really is as fixed as it later becomes. We know also that even in the 18th and early 19th century there's some kind of particular association with the Southwestern region of the Korean Peninsula, but we also know that some performers also came from other places, right?

So whether it originates entirely within this region or whether it is something that has more kind of artistic regional origins, the debate about this remains. But we do know that within the 18th century, people kind of think of it in relationship to this Southwestern region. In the 19th century, we have a lot more sort of detailed documentation of all kinds of different facets of pansori performance, and this is what we can really identify as the kind of peak of, like, and sort of frequency of performance in Korean history. But even this period is not really static, right? There's also kind of ongoing change throughout this era. And a lot of this variation has to do with things that we introduced in the last unit, right?

Just this idea that this is a living tradition that's transmitted orally from teacher to student. These techniques are flexible and fluid. Different people are going to emphasize different aspects of the performance. They're going to choose to perform things in a particular way based on their own school, but even based on their own unique personal style. So, this is still a very kind of diverse and eclectic tradition, even if the kind of basic parameters of it remain the same throughout the 19th. This continues into the 20th century, but we have these new factors of new media technology in the form of audio recording and cinema, which are both like influences, venues for popularization and new audiences, but also potential competitors, potential sort of distractions from this other

form.

And then we also have the role played by the Japanese occupation during the early 20th century, which in its own way transformed pansori, introduced new kinds of performances of a certain kind, but also sort of heavily restricted kinds of performances were possible and were transmitted during that period. This is followed by a kind of revitalization and standardization of the form in like roughly the 1960s and beyond, in which we see the emergence of this kind of standardized, widespread, and sort of elevated status, like heritage style of Pansori, start to become more popular. But as in earlier traditions, we see that even those traditional performers, right, even those that are the most devoted to revitalizing, and restoring a kind of authentic tradition of Pansori performance to be authentic within the style of performance is to kind of blend this inheritance from the past with unique personal style.

Right? Part of what makes individual performers exciting is when they can do things differently from everybody else around them, but another thing that makes them entertaining and appealing to people is how well they're able to sort of reproduce the things that people liked about performers from generations past. Right? So even within what we might think of as the most sort of like standardized style of traditional performance, there's still a lot of opportunity for unique personal flourishes for differences among schools and so on. And in addition to that, we also have this kind of radically sort of innovative and new style of performance that in some cases is kind of positioned against the, like, mainstream national cultural interest; in other cases, we could think of as a sort of like different approach to revitalization and restoration. We can understand these as efforts to preserve and maintain Pansori by encouraging and allowing it to sort of change to adapt to suit what audiences want in the present. And so, all of this again we'll talk about in the following unit of the class. But that kind of brings us from, you know, very early history up till roughly the present.

So what I'd like us to do next, or rather what you will be doing next, is finishing both a writing assignment and, as usual, a. So the assignment, as with a lot of these, is gonna be sort of thinking laterally as a way of understanding some of the concepts and ideas in this unit. So what I'd like us to do for this is to think of two examples from contemporary culture, from wherever you choose, right? These are just sort of complimentary examples from either pop culture or traditional culture, if you want, that we can use to kind of think through some of these ideas about origins and the complexity of studying them. So, one of the examples you think of, I'd like you to find something that you think it's relatively easy to say, okay, this is something that originates at this particular point in time, and here is where it is in the present.

You don't have to tell that whole story, but something that you can introduce the origins of relatively quickly. And then, by contrast, a kind of complimentary or related example of something that you think has maybe a more complex or obscure kind of multifaceted history. This is very open-ended. Again, the goal is just to kind of think through some of these ideas. I'd like in your writing to introduce those two examples, with particular attention to the factors that let you contrast their origins. Right? You can say this is a kind of simple one, this is one that's more complex, and here's why. Just a couple of paragraphs kind of explaining the contrast between those two examples. Now,

the best way to do this of would be in a way that also allows you to kind of make some connections with the history of Pansori that we've covered in the readings and lecture today.

But your focus should be on kind of introducing and thinking through the two examples. that you choose. Then we'll have a, as usual, it's gonna be five questions and 10 minutes. The details will come from those two chapters of the Korean Singer of Tales and the additional content I provided in the lecture just now. You don't need to memorize every single Korean word that's used in that reading. Those that also come up and are very well defined in today's lecture, there's gonna be kind of less helpful. I do kind of expect you to, pansori for example, is a term that you should know the meaning of. Other terms, if it's necessary for them to appear on the quiz, I'll kind of give you a brief definition on screen as well, right?

So it's not necessary to come up with a kind of vocabulary list and memorize what all of those words mean prior to taking the. Similarly, dates are important. Dates are very interesting, but you might notice that in my lecture today I kind of downplayed precisely what year or what decade things occur in. We can think in terms of century, right? These kind of broad cross sections of and pay particular attention to chronological details and place names and stuff that I've reiterated in the lecture. Again, the reading covers much broader ground. I'm trying to kind of narrow things down to help you focus through the lecture which will. also help you prepare for the quiz. All right, thanks everybody. And that's all for this lecture. I'll see you back again for the lecture in the third and final unit of this module, where we'll go into contemporary pansori performance.